

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

PCs lying about their disk space? Refusing to talk sans a password? Here's how you get them to behave!

Farewell, 98

Q I dual-boot Windows 98 on the C drive and Windows XP Pro on the D drive. Now I don't want to use Windows 98, but since it is on a primary partition, whenever I format it, Windows XP fails to load since it is on the secondary partition. How can I format Windows 98 without losing the existing Windows XP? I have a Ghost backup (Symantec Ghost) of both partitions.

Darshan Wadikar

A When you formatted your C drive, Windows 98 was removed, but along with it went the boot.ini file, which is required for Windows to boot properly. We suggest you perform a repair of your OS. To do this, boot your computer using your Windows XP CD, and when presented with the options called "To install Windows XP, press enter" and "To repair your computer using the recovery console, press R", press [Enter]. When you're presented with the list of installed OSes, select Windows XP and press [R] to repair it, and follow the on-screen instructions. This should fix the boot.ini file, and you should be able to use your Windows XP installation as it is.

Should you choose to use your Ghost backup

```
boot.ini - Notepad
File Edit Format View Help
[boot loader]
timeout=30
default=multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(1)\WINDOWS
[operating systems]
multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(1)\WIN98="Microsoft Windows 98 Professional"
multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(2)\WINDOWS="Microsoft Windows XP Professional" /Execute
```

you can also set timeout=0 to get your PC to boot immediately in Windows XP

and restore the drive to its original state, we suggest restoring only the backup for the C drive. You can then boot into Windows XP and delete the Windows folder (the folder where Windows 98 is installed) from the C drive, and remove the Windows 98 entry from boot.ini located in the root of the C drive, using Notepad. This entry should look something like

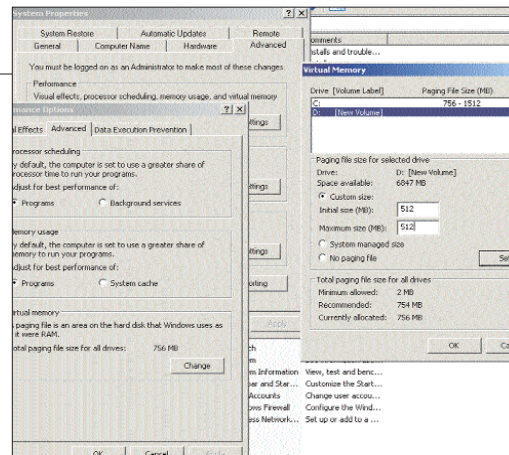
"multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(1)\WINDOWS="Microsoft Windows 98" /Execute"

Memory Doesn't Serve

Q Whenever I play *Gun* for five to 10 minutes, it crashes and gives an error saying "virtual memory too low." My computer is a Pentium 4 with an Intel original motherboard, and 256 MB of DDR RAM, with Windows XP SP2. What can I do?

Prajkt Yeole

A It seems the partition where the virtual memory is stored has run out of space or,



Remember to click SET to save your changes before clicking OK

like the error says, your virtual memory is set to too low a value. You can change the partition where the virtual memory is stored, and/or increase the amount of virtual memory. Go through the following steps.

- ❑ In the Control Panel, double-click on the System icon. Next, click the Advanced tab and click the Settings button under Performance at the top.
- ❑ Again, click on the Advanced tab and click Change.
- ❑ You will be presented with a list of drives at the top with the swap file allocated to them shown on the left.
- ❑ Highlight a drive where virtual memory is not already allocated, and click on the Custom Size radio button.
- ❑ Enter an amount that is at least twice the amount of your RAM. In this case it would be 512 MB, though if you wish, you can enter more. After you are done allocating the swap file to a partition, click Set.
- ❑ Next, highlight one of the drives where virtual memory was already allocated, click "No Paging File", then click Set, and finally OK to apply changes. Restart.

Damn Drivers!

Q I have an HP m7382in Media Center PC with a Pentium D 2.8 GHz, 1 GB DDR2 RAM (533 MHz), and an ATI Radeon X1300 Pro graphics card. Upon starting Windows, I get this error:

"Title bar contents: ATI video bios poller client: ATI2evxx.exe—Application Error

The instruction at "0x7c910f29" referenced memory at "0x00000000". The memory could not be read."

Why does the error appear, and what can I do?

Ashish Masurekar

A Your problem is directly related to ATI's drivers. To troubleshoot your problem, you can try the following:

- ❑ Use Driver Cleaner from www.drivercleaner.net and eliminate all traces of your previous ATI drivers. Then download the latest drivers from <http://www.ati.com/support/driver.html> and install them.
- ❑ If the latest drivers don't work, try using an earlier version of the ATI drivers. You'll find these too at ATI's Web site.

Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!